BrightLearn
BUSINESS ANALYTICS

RESEARCH ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 01

The Language of Business Analytics

A research-based glossary assignment. Define the essential terms, KPIs, and concepts that form the foundation of how modern businesses use data to make decisions.

COURSE
Business Analytics — Foundations

TYPE
Research & Terminology

TERMS
38 essential concepts to define

SOURCES
Minimum 5 credible references

Research · Define · Apply
Build the vocabulary of an analyst.

00 Assignment Overview

Every great analyst starts by mastering the language of the field. In this assignment you will research and define **38 essential terms** used across Business Analytics — covering foundational concepts, types of data, KPIs, and marketing campaign analytics.

★ LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this assignment you will be able to:

- Identify and correctly use the core vocabulary of Business and Data Analytics.
- Distinguish between commonly confused terms (e.g., metric vs. KPI, CAC vs. CLV).
- Recognize the key performance indicators used to measure marketing and business success.
- Connect each concept to a real-world business situation where it applies.

FOR EACH TERM, PROVIDE:

1 DEFINITION

Explain the term in your own words — 2 to 3 clear sentences. Do not copy-paste from the web.

2 REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Give one short example showing how the term is used in a real business or industry.

3 SOURCE

Cite the credible source(s) you used to research the term. Use a consistent referencing style.

SUBMISSION FORMAT

- **Document:** One PDF or Word file, organized into the same four sections used in this brief.
- **Length:** Approximately 6–10 pages, depending on detail.
- **Sources:** Minimum 5 credible academic or industry sources, properly referenced (Harvard Business Review, McKinsey, Investopedia, Statista, course textbook, etc.).
- **Originality:** All definitions must be in your own words. AI-generated text and copy-pasting from the internet will be graded as zero.
- **Format:** Term name in **bold**, followed by your definition, example, and source.

01 Foundational Concepts of Analytics

These are the building-block concepts every analyst must understand before going deeper. They describe *what* analytics is and the different ways businesses use data to think about the past, present, and future.

01 **Business Analytics**
The discipline itself

02 **Data Analytics**
Often confused with Business Analytics

03 **Business Intelligence (BI)**
Reporting & insight tools

04 **Data-Driven Decision Making**
A modern management philosophy

05 **Big Data**
Volume, velocity, variety

06 **Descriptive Analytics**
"What happened?"

07 **Diagnostic Analytics**
"Why did it happen?"

08 **Predictive Analytics**
"What is likely to happen?"

09 **Prescriptive Analytics**
"What should we do about it?"

10 **Data Literacy**
A key 21st-century skill

★ PRO TIP — DON'T JUST DEFINE, DISTINGUISH

Several of these terms overlap — for example, Business Analytics, Data Analytics, and Business Intelligence are often used interchangeably in industry, but they are **not** the same. In your definitions, make the differences clear. A strong answer doesn't just say what something is; it says what it is *not*.

02 Data, Measurement & Reporting

Analytics depends on knowing what data exists, where it lives, and how it gets turned into something a decision-maker can use. This section covers the data infrastructure and reporting concepts every analyst should know.

11 Structured Data
Rows and columns

12 Unstructured Data
Text, images, audio, video

13 Data Warehouse
Central storage for analytics

14 Data Mining
Discovering patterns

15 Data Visualization
Charts, graphs, infographics

16 Dashboard
A live view of performance

17 Metric
Any measurable number

18 Key Performance Indicator (KPI)
A metric that drives decisions

19 Benchmark
A reference point for comparison

20 Segmentation
Grouping customers by attributes

★ LOOK FOR THE DIFFERENCE

Pay special attention to **Metric vs. KPI**. Every KPI is a metric — but not every metric is a KPI. In your definition, make this distinction crystal clear, and give an example of a number that is "just a metric" for one company but a "KPI" for another.

03 Customer & Sales KPIs

These are the most-watched KPIs in any company that sells to customers. Each one answers a specific business question about how well the company attracts, converts, and keeps customers — and how much profit each customer brings in.

21 Conversion Rate
% of visitors who take action

22 Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)
Cost of gaining one new customer

23 Customer Lifetime Value (CLV / LTV)
Total profit per customer over time

24 Churn Rate
% of customers who leave

25 Customer Retention Rate
The opposite of churn

26 Net Promoter Score (NPS)
Would your customers recommend you?

27 Average Order Value (AOV)
Revenue per transaction

28 Sales Funnel
From awareness to purchase

★ THE MOST IMPORTANT RATIO IN BUSINESS

When you research **CAC** and **CLV**, also explain the **CLV : CAC ratio**. It is one of the most-watched health metrics in modern business — a healthy ratio means a company earns far more from each customer than it spends to acquire them. A bad ratio can sink even a fast-growing company.

04 Marketing & Campaign Analytics

Marketing campaigns are one of the largest budget items in most businesses — and one of the most measured. The terms below describe how campaigns are designed, tracked, and evaluated through data.

29 Marketing Campaign
A coordinated marketing effort

30 Post-Campaign Analysis
Measuring what worked

31 Incremental Revenue
Extra revenue caused by the campaign

32 Return on Investment (ROI)
The classic profitability test

33 Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)
Revenue per advertising dollar

34 Click-Through Rate (CTR)
% of viewers who click

35 Bounce Rate
% of visitors who leave quickly

36 A/B Testing
Comparing two versions

37 Lead Generation
Capturing potential customers

38 Marketing Attribution
Which channel deserves the credit?

★ CONNECT THESE TERMS

Many of these concepts work together. **Post-campaign analysis** uses **incremental revenue** and **ROI** to judge a campaign's success. **A/B testing** tells you which version of an ad performed better. **Attribution** tells you which channel (email, social, search) actually drove the result. In your definitions, mention how these terms relate to each other where relevant.

05 Marking Rubric & Sources

Your work will be graded against the criteria below. A high-scoring submission shows that you have genuinely researched each term — not just paraphrased the first definition you found online.

CRITERION	WHAT WE'RE LOOKING FOR	WEIGHT
Accuracy of Definitions	Each term is defined correctly and clearly. Misconceptions and overlaps are addressed.	35%
Originality & Clarity	Definitions are written in your own words and easy to understand. No copy-paste, no AI-generated text.	25%
Real-World Examples	Each term is illustrated with a concrete, relevant business or industry example.	20%
Coverage & Completeness	All 38 terms are addressed. None are skipped or treated superficially.	10%
Citations & Presentation	Minimum 5 credible sources cited consistently. Document is well-formatted and easy to navigate.	10%

★ SUGGESTED STARTING SOURCES

You are not limited to these — but they are excellent places to begin your research:

- **Harvard Business Review (hbr.org)** — articles on data-driven decision-making and KPIs.
- **McKinsey & Company Insights** — strategy and analytics case studies.
- **Investopedia** — for clear definitions of financial and business terms.
- **Google Analytics Help & Skillshop** — for marketing KPIs and conversion concepts.
- **HubSpot Academy** — free certifications on inbound marketing and analytics.
- **Statista** — for credible industry data and benchmarks.
- **Course textbook:** *Business Analytics* by James R. Evans (or your assigned reading).

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY REMINDER

You may use AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini) to help you understand a concept — but every definition you submit must be written in your own words after you have understood the term. Plagiarized or AI-generated text will be graded as zero. **Define what you can explain.**

Master the language.
Master the field.

Every analyst, marketer, and business leader speaks this vocabulary fluently. Once you can define these 38 terms in your own words — and explain them to a friend — you have the foundation to do real analytics work.

★ BRIGHTLEARN BUSINESS ANALYTICS ★

Research Assignment Module 01 27/04/2026

The Language of Business Analytics

Section 01

0.1 Business Analytics
- is the use of data, tools and techniques to analyze business performance and help in better decision making. It focuses on improving outcomes using insights from data.

Examples:
- Analyzing companies sales data to decide which product to promote

0.2 Data Analytics
-> is examining or analysing raw data to find trends and insights in a business.

* Example
-> A hospital analyzes patients data to improve treatment plans.

Source: IBM / investopedia

0.3 Business Intelligence (BI)
-> Refers to tools and systems used to collect, analyze and present business data through reports, it focuses on past and current performance

* Example
- A hospital using Power BI dashboards to track monthly or daily patient's recovery.

Source: IBM / Microsoft

08. Predictive Analytics
-> We use historical data to forecast future outcomes.
example
-> Predicting future Sales based on previous performance
Source : Havard Business (Online.hbs.edu)

09 Prescriptive Analytics.
-> We Suggest actions to take based on data analysis and predictions.
~~*~~ Example
-> Recommending which product to promote to increase Sales..
Source: Ibm.Com

10. Data Literacy.
-> The ability to read, understand and work with data effectively
Example:
An employee interpreting a Chart to Make decisions.
Source : IbM.

04. Data-Driven Decision Making.
- Refers to Making decisions based on data analysis rather than intuition or guesswork. It ensures decisions are backed by ~~ex~~ evidence.
* Example
→ Creating a campaign after analyzing Customer demand data.
Source: Havard Business Review.

05. Big Data
-> The large and complex datasets that require advanced tools to process due to their sizes or volumes
Example
-> Social Media platforms analyze Millions of user interactions daily.
Source: IBM.

06 Descriptive Analytics.
-> It focuses on summarizing past data to understand what has happened.
Example
-> Analyzing why Sales have dropped in a specific Month.
Source: Investopedia / qlik

07. Diagnostic Analytics
-> Explains why Something happened by analyzing data performance and relationships
example
-> A report shows last Month's performance dropping and analyzing what happened.

Section 2: Data & Reporting.

11. Structured Data
-> Is a data organized in rows and Columns
example
-> Spreadsheets showing patients register.

12 Unstructured Data
-> Data without fixed format / unorganized data.
Example:
-> Videos, Images and texts.

13 Data Warehouse
-> A Central System where large amounts of data are stored for analysis.
Example: Storing patients information from different Clinics to evaluate treating Methods.
Source: Coursera
14 Data Mining
-> The process of discovering patterns and insights from large datasets.
Example: Identify high-risk patients by analyzing Electronic Health records and predicts disease
15. Data Visualization
-> Presenting data using Charts, graphs or Visuals.

16 Dashboard
-> A Visual display of key data and performance Metric in real time

17. Metric
-> A Measurable Value used to track performance

18. Key Performance Indicator (KPI)
-> A high-level Measurement used to track progress towards specific Objectives. It evaluates the effectiveness and efficiency of the business
example
-> Sales: Number of New Costumers; Sales Conversion rate.

Source:

19 Bench Mark.
-> A Standard use to Compare performance
Example:
Comparing Employees Satisfaction Scores.

Source: Business News Daily

20 Segmentation
-> A Marketing Strategy that involves dividing Customers into groups based on shared characteristics.
example:
-> A Luxury Car brand targeting high-income individuals While budget brands target price-sensitive Consumers
Source: Investopedia.

Section 3. Customer and Sales KPIs.

21. Conversion Rate
-> The percentage of users who take a desired action
example
-> In-App action: tracking users who install an app and completed a tutorial
Source: Adjust / Cambridge dictionary.

22. Customer Acquisition.
-> The total expense a business incurs to convince a potential customer to buy a product.
Source: Wikipedia

23 Customer Lifetime Value (CLV/LTV)
-> Total Revenue a business expects from a customer over time.
Example:
-> Comparing CLV to CAC to ensure profitable Marketing, ideally aiming for a 3:1 ratio.
Source: IBM

24 Churn rate.
-> Percentage of Customers who stops using a service or stops doing business with a company over a specific period.
Example:
-> High Churn Suggesting customers are Moving to a Competitor with better Value.
Source: Investopedia

25. Customer Retention Rate
-> Percentage of Customers who stays with a Company.
Source: Productiv.io

26 Net Promoter Score (NPS)
-> Measures Customer Satisfaction based on recommendations.
Source: Qualtrics.com.

27. Average Order Value. (AOV)
-> Average amount spent per purchase, Calculated by dividing total revenue by the number of Orders
Source: Geckoboard.com.

28. Sales funnel.
-> The Customers Journey from awareness to purchase.
Source: IBM.

Section 4 Marketing and Campaign Analytics

29. Marketing Campaign.
-> A strategic, organized series of activities designed to promote a product.
Source: Indeed.com

30. Post-Campaign Analysis.
-> Evaluating the results of a Marketing Campaign
Source: Growth-onomics.

31. Incremental Revenue
-> Additional income in a business generated by a marketing campaign.
Source: Ringy CRM.

32. Return on Investment (ROI)
-> Measures profitability compared to cost
Source: Esade

33. Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)
-> Revenue earned for each unit of advertising cost.
Source: Adjust

34. Click-Through Rate (CTR)
- A digital marketing that measures the percentage of people who click on ads or specific links.
Source: Investopedia.

35. Bounce Rate
→ Percentage of Visitors who enters a website and leave after viewing only one page without interacting.
Source: Wikipedia

36. A/B Testing.
→ Comparing two Versions of a digital asset - 'A' (control) and B (Variant) to determine which performs better.
Source: Adobe for Business

37. Lead Generation
-> The process of collecting potential customers information

38. Market Attribution
-> The process of Identifying which Chanel lead to a Conversion.